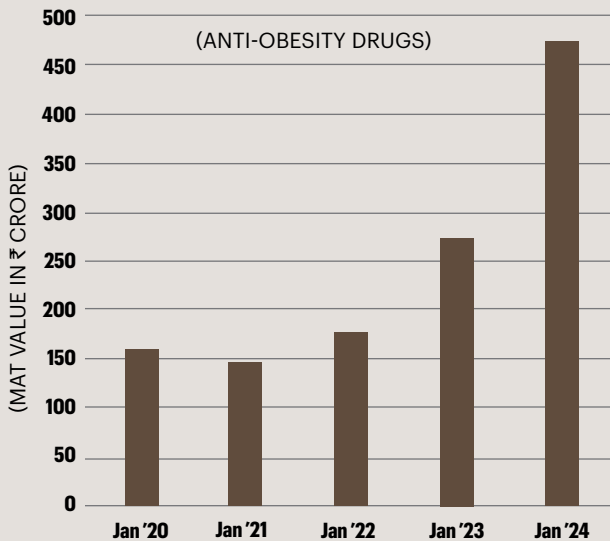


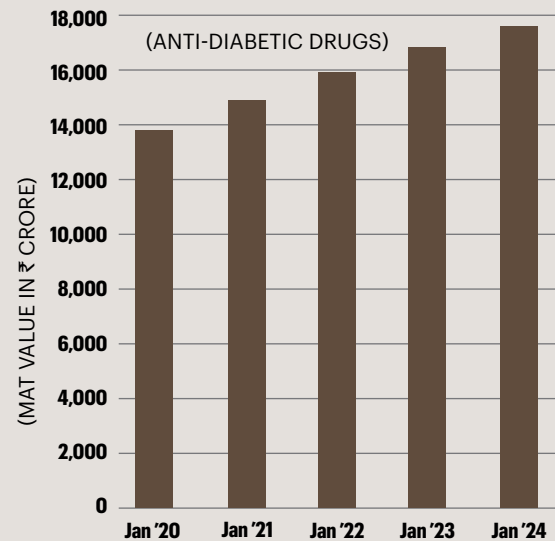
SOARING DEMAND

- Anti-obesity drugs in India have seen a massive surge in the last three years and are continuing their run in 2024
- Other subgroups have witnessed stable performance over the same period



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- The market value of anti-diabetic drugs has shown steady growth over the past five years
- Each year, there is an increase in the market value of anti-diabetic drugs compared to the previous year



‘Overweight’ is when your body mass index or BMI is greater than or equal to 25; ‘obese’ is when your BMI is equal to or greater than 30, which makes you prone to several chronic conditions.

India’s fifth National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5), from 2019 to 2021, shows that 33% of urban women and 30% of urban men (in the age group of 15-49 years) are overweight or obese. Obesity affects over 135 million individuals, making it a significant health concern.

Lilly intends to expand in India’s steadily increasing obesity and diabetes market. Zepbound hit 25,000 new prescriptions a week in the US in December 2023, just a month after the US Food and Drug Administration (FDA) approved it for treating the overweight and obese. Mounjaro, earlier used for diabetes, was also approved in the US, UK and Europe in November 2023 for weight loss.

Vineet Gupta, Associate VP-MD India and Alliances, Eli Lilly & Co., says the company will launch Mounjaro for both obesity and Type 2 diabetes.

“It is currently under regulatory review ...our current estimate is that we should be able to bring the stock to India in 2025,” says Gupta.

According to the India Diabetes Report of the Indian Council of Medical Research, released in 2023, India has 101 million diabetics. That’s more than the popula-

tion of Vietnam!

David A. Ricks, Chair & CEO of Eli Lilly & Co., says the US parent is working with the Indian team to develop a plan. “Our overarching goal is to distribute our medicines globally, including in India, as swiftly as possible, recognising the urgency for individuals with chronic diseases (diabetes and obesity),” he says.

“However, we face a significant constraint concerning supply chain capacity, as our systems were initially designed for a smaller market than what the obesity segment demands. We must devise a strategy that balances supply availability with market demand,” says the CEO. “Obesity catalyses over 200 chronic diseases, prompting our exploration of various treatment avenues,” says Ricks.

In general, anti-obesity drugs act by mimicking some hormones that make you feel satiated or suppressing some brain centres related to hunger.

FATTENING THE BASE

Lilly is leveraging its portfolio that includes drugs for breast cancer (Ramiven) and psoriasis (Copellor). The company launched Ramiven in November 2022 and Copellor in March 2023. “We are excelling in these segments. In breast cancer, we lead the market in terms of value. In psoriasis, our drug, launched a year ago, has